TC066 Front / BIFF

The clean-reply frame for hot messages

BIFF formula

Brief: one short paragraph. Informative: facts only. Friendly: civil tone. Firm: next step, boundary, or close.

Minimum viable move

Thanks for sending this. [Relevant fact.] [Next step or limit.]

Use when

A reply is needed, but the message contains bait, hostility, inaccurate claims, repeated allegations, or false urgency.

Avoid when

Safety escalation is needed, a fuller apology is owed, the person needs care, or the issue requires detailed consent/negotiation.

Three sentences usually beat three paragraphs.

TC066 Back / BIFF

Calibration, recovery and neighbour distinctions

Before sending

Remove sarcasm, motive defence, blame history, diagnoses, and every point that does not require a practical reply.

Neighbour choice

Use BLUF for briefing clarity. Use SBI for feedback. Use NVC / OFNR for relationship repair. Use BIFF for hostile replies.

Recovery

If you over-explain: I am going to simplify my earlier reply: the next step is ___. If you sound harsh: Let me restate that more calmly: ___.

Boundary close

I will respond to new information, not repeated allegations. I am available for logistics, not personal accusations.

Short. Factual. Civil. Closed.